WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

BURKINA FASO

Africa

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Ouagadougou	Capital and seat of government; centre for banking, public procurement, company registration and the Commercial Court	Financial services, telecoms, construction, public works
Bobo-Dioulasso (west)	Second city and commercial centre of the west, with its own Commercial Court	Agro-processing, agribusiness, logistics, light manufacturing
Industrial gold belt (multiple regions)	Gold accounts for nearly 90% of exports; the 2024 Mining Code has increased state participation in new and existing mines	Gold mining, mining services, local supply chains
New gold projects (e.g. Kiaka, Bomboré)	Recent mine developments where state participation is agreed case by case, with officials describing requests for added stakes as negotiated rather than imposed	Mine development, contracting, equipment, processing
Power generation build-out (nationwide)	The PND 2026–2030 targets installed capacity of about 2,585 MW, up from about 680 MW in 2024	Solar, hydropower, storage, distribution
Coastal trade corridors	As a landlocked economy, Burkina Faso moves imports and exports by road and rail through the ports of neighbouring coastal states	Transport, logistics, warehousing, fuel distribution

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Burkinabè Investment Agency (ABI), the national investment promotion agency, which replaced the former API-BF in 2018
- Investment Code (Law No. 038-2018/AN) offering privileged tax and customs regimes by investment size, with foreign investors in principle treated equally with domestic investors
- 2024 Mining Code providing a 15% free-carried state interest and a state option on a further paid stake of at least 30%, with additional equity open to the state and local investors on commercial terms
- WAEMU membership and the euro-pegged CFA franc under the BCEAO, with exchange controls set by WAEMU rules and transfers made through authorised financial intermediaries
- OHADA uniform business law, with Commercial Courts in Ouagadougou and Bobo-Dioulasso, ICSID membership since 1966 and the New York Convention on foreign arbitral awards
- Centre de Formalités des Entreprises (CEFORE) providing one-stop company registration

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Burkina Faso enters late 2026 with markedly stronger macroeconomic foundations. Real GDP grew 5.3% in 2025, up from 4.8% in 2024, and inflation averaged -0.5%. Exports rose about 63% on higher gold prices, turning the current account from a deficit of 3.5% of GDP to a surplus of 6.3%, while the fiscal deficit narrowed from 5.8% to 1.8% of GDP and public debt stood at 53.4% of GDP. In June 2026 the IMF completed its fifth review of the Extended Credit Facility and approved an augmentation taking total access to about $395 million, alongside a Resilience and Sustainability Facility of about $124 million. The IMF expects growth of 3.6% in 2026 and 4.8% in 2027, and government borrowing costs have fallen, with securities yields as low as 7.1% in April 2026.

Security is the defining structural challenge. Burkina Faso remains among the countries most affected by terrorism, around 2.1 million people are internally displaced, and the US advises against all travel. The economy has nonetheless grown by around 5% a year. Policy is also shifting towards greater state participation, notably in gold, where two operating mines and three exploration licences were transferred to the state miner SOPAMIB in June 2025, and the country left ECOWAS in January 2025 to build the Alliance of Sahel States (AES) while remaining in WAEMU and the CFA franc zone. For investors, this points to an opportunity built on partnership: projects aligned with national priorities in power, agro-processing, local mining supply chains and the PND 2026–2030, structured with local partners and backed by robust security and contractual planning.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Security and travel restrictions	Burkina Faso ranks second on the Global Terrorism Index, terrorists reportedly control 30–35% of the territory, and the US maintains a Level 4 advisory	Focus on Ouagadougou, Bobo-Dioulasso and secured sites, with professional security, insurance and duty-of-care planning
Expanding state role in mining	The 2024 Mining Code raises state equity rights, and five gold assets were transferred to the state in 2025	Engage early with SOPAMIB and the authorities; supply, services, processing and negotiated partnership models remain open
Regional realignment (ECOWAS exit, AES)	Exit from ECOWAS took effect on 29 January 2025, creating new regional arrangements to track	The IMF judges the fallout limited; WAEMU membership preserves the currency anchor and regional financial market
Dependence on gold	Gold accounts for nearly 90% of exports, making revenues sensitive to prices and output	The new sovereign mining fund (FSMIB) is designed to channel surplus mining revenue into infrastructure and industry, supporting diversification
Governance and transparency	Burkina Faso scored 41 on the 2024 Corruption Perceptions Index, above the Sub-Saharan average of 33	Use Investment Code benefits, OHADA law and arbitration clauses; seven of eleven IMF governance priorities are already implemented
Landlocked logistics and imported energy	Reliance on coastal corridors and exposure to oil price volatility raise costs	The PND plan to almost quadruple power capacity by 2030 creates openings in solar, storage and distribution
Limited access to local credit	Private credit contracted by 2.2% in 2024 and 4.1% in 2025, constraining local partners and suppliers	Falling government bond yields (7.1% in April 2026) and a BCEAO rate cut in March 2026 are easing conditions; bring external or DFI-backed financing

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Burkina Faso combines improving macroeconomic fundamentals — 5.3% growth, a narrowing fiscal deficit, an external surplus and sustained IMF programme support — with a security and political environment that investors must assess plainly. The country is led by military transitional authorities under Captain Ibrahim Traoré; it is not subject to broad international economic sanctions, but the US Level 4 travel advisory and Burkina Faso's suspension of visas for US citizens since 30 December 2025 affect mobility and due diligence. The state's expanding role in mining means project terms, ownership and local participation should be agreed carefully and documented. With a stable CFA franc anchor within WAEMU, IMF engagement and a clear national development

plan, investors who use local legal counsel, security advisers and political-risk insurance can position for sectors where national priorities and private capital meet.

MARKET ACCESS

Burkina Faso is a member of the eight-country West African Economic and Monetary Union (WAEMU), sharing the euro-pegged CFA franc and a regional government securities market, and of the OHADA business-law area. Following its exit from ECOWAS on 29 January 2025, it is a founding member of the Alliance of Sahel States with Mali and Niger, whose Confederal Investment and Development Bank (BCID-AES) was activated in December 2025 to finance transport, energy and mining infrastructure. Burkina Faso has been a WTO member since 1995. Gold dominates exports, going mostly to Switzerland, and trade moves through road and rail corridors to coastal ports in neighbouring states.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Presidency of Faso (Captain Ibrahim Traoré)	Leads the transition and sets economic sovereignty, security and development priorities	Primary reference point for strategic direction and major project approvals
Burkinabè Investment Agency (ABI)	National investment promotion agency guiding investors through the Investment Code and its privileged regimes	Standard first point of contact for market entry and incentives
BCEAO (Central Bank of West African States)	Regional central bank managing the CFA franc and monetary policy across WAEMU; cut its policy rate by 25 basis points in March 2026	Relevant for currency, transfers and banking-sector matters
Ministry of Economy and Finance	Leads the PND 2026–2030, the IMF programme, budget and regional debt issuance; the minister has chaired the WAEMU Council of Ministers since October 2025	Key counterpart for public-private partnerships and fiscal incentives
SOPAMIB (Société de Participation Minière du Burkina)	State mining company set up to own, manage and operate strategic mining assets, including those transferred in 2025	Essential counterpart for any gold-sector partnership or supply arrangement
Sovereign Mining Investment Fund (FSMIB)	Created by decree in May 2026 to channel surplus mining revenue into long-term infrastructure and industrial projects	Potential co-investor in infrastructure and industrial projects as its governance is finalised
Confederal Investment and Development Bank (BCID-AES)	AES development bank activated in December 2025 with initial capital of CFAF 500 billion	Relevant for co-financing transport, energy and mining infrastructure across Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of Burkina Faso is the principal channel to domestic business, supporting feasibility studies and business links, and CEFORE streamlines company set-up. The Burkinabè Investment Agency is the entry point for Investment Code incentives. The IMF, through its Extended Credit Facility and Resilience and Sustainability Facility, and the World Bank, through its country programme and regular Economic Updates, remain active and are a useful source of macroeconomic and policy insight. The WAEMU regional securities market, the 2026 diaspora bond seeking CFAF 125 billion and the BCID-AES are emerging channels for co-financing infrastructure.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Burkina Faso best suits experienced frontier-market investors with a high tolerance for security risk and a long-term, partnership-based approach: renewable energy and power developers responding to the plan to almost quadruple installed capacity by 2030; agribusiness and agro-processing investors serving domestic and regional markets; mining services, equipment and processing firms supplying a sector with strong state-participation

objectives; and telecoms, fintech and financial-services investors serving a growing population. Investors should be comfortable partnering with state entities and planning for security and regional-policy developments.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage the Burkinabè Investment Agency and assess Investment Code regimes
Open dialogue with ABI to identify the applicable privileged regime and prepare the approval application.

STEP 2: Commission security, legal and political-risk due diligence
Retain local counsel and security advisers, review travel and visa restrictions and duty-of-care obligations, and secure political-risk insurance before committing capital.

STEP 3: Align projects with the PND 2026–2030 and state partners
Position proposals in power, agro-processing and mining supply chains to match national priorities, engaging SOPAMIB and relevant ministries early.

STEP 4: Structure contracts for predictability
Use Investment Code approvals, OHADA-compliant structures and international arbitration clauses, drawing on ICSID and New York Convention membership.

STEP 5: Track regional and financing developments
Follow AES integration, ECOWAS relations, BCEAO policy and new co-financing sources such as the FSMIB and BCID-AES.